INCH-POUND

MIL-DTL-3636D
23 August 2024
SUPERSEDING
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15 November 1969

DETAIL SPECIFICATION

CORD AND TASSELS, FLAG

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers the requirements for cords and tassels to be used with the flags (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification. Backing plates will be of the following types (see 6. 2)

Class 1 - Old Glory Red, White and National Flag Blue
Class 2 - Defense Blue and White
Class 3 - Scarlet and White
Class 4 - Old Glory Blue and White
Class 5 - Ultramarine Blue and Air Force Yellow
Class 6 - Silver Gray Black and Golden Yellow
Class 7 - Golden Yellow
Class 8 - Scarlet and Golden Yellow
Class 9 - Silver Gray and Black

2 APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.2 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6,2).

Comments, suggestions, or questions on this document should be addressed to The Institute of Heraldry, ATTN: Technical and Production Division, 9325 Gunston Road, Room S-108, Fort Belvoir, VA 22060-5579 or email to usarmy.belvoir.hqda.mbx.tioh-webmaster@army.mil. You may verify the currency of this specification using the ASSIST Online database at https://assist.dla.mil.

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FEDERAL STANDARDS

PPP-B676 - Boxes, Setup

MILITARY STANDARD

MIL-STD-129 - Military Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-1916 – DOD Preferred Methods for Acceptance of Product

(Copies of these documents are available online at https://quicksearch.dla.mil).

2.2. Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

The Institute of Heraldry Drawings:

Figure 1 - TASSEL AND CORD (see figure1)

(Copies of standards, drawings and Chip sets are available from The Institute of Heraldry, ATTN: Technical and Production Division, 9325 Gunston Road, Room S-108, Fort Belvoir, VA 22060-5579 or usarmy.belvoir.hqda.mi.tioh-webmaster@mail.mil.)

2.3. Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents are those cited in the solicitation or contract.

ASTM INTERNATIONAL

ASTM D4689 - Adhesive, Casein-Type
ASTM D6251 - Natural Wood-Cleated Panelboard shipping Boxes
ASTM D5118/D5118M- Boxes, Fiberboard Shipping Fabrication of
ASTM D6880/D6880M - Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner

(Copies for these documents are available online at https://www.astm.org)

AMERICAN AND EFIRD, LLC
DoD Standard Shades for Heraldic Yarns, 2012 Edition

(Copies for these documents are available online at www.salesRA@amefird.com).

The Color Association of The United States

THE STANDARD COLOR REFERENCE OF AMERICA, 10TH EDITION and supplement, THE U.S. ARMY COLOR CARD

(These color references can be obtained from The Color Association of the United States, 315 West 39th Street, Studio 507, New York, NY 10018, telephone: 212 947-7774, www.colorassociation.com.)

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Cordage Institute

CI-1500 - TEST METHODS FOR FIBER ROPE
CI-1303 - NYLON (POLYAMIDE) FIBER ROPE, 3-Strand and 8-Strand Constructions
CI-1304 - POLYESTER (PET) FIBER ROPE, 3-Strand and 8-Strand Constructions
CI-1321 - NYLON (POLYAMIDE) FIBER CORD/ROPE, Solid Braid Constructions
CI-1322 – POLYESTER (PET) RIBER CORD/ROPE, Solid Braid Constructions

(These standards are available from the Cordage Institute, 994 Old Eagle School Road, Ste. 1019, Wayne, Pennsylvania 29087-1866, telephone 610-971-4854, www.ropecord.com.)

3 REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Guide sample Samples, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information to the contractor (see 6.3). Variation from this specification my appear in the sample in which case this specification shall govern.

3.2 First article. When required (see 6.2), before production is commenced, a sample or samples of the finished item shall be submitted to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for inspection as specified in 4.2. The approval of the first article authorizes the commencement of production but does not relieve the contractor of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The first article shall be manufactured by the contractor in the same facilities to be used for the production items.

3.3 Material

3.3.1 Rayon yarn The yarn shall be continuous multifilament bright regenerated cellulose Rayon. If the cord is machine twisted there shall be a minimum of 15 ends of 300 denier, 44 filaments per end; if hand twisted there shall be a minimum of 6 ends of 300 denier, 44 filaments per end.

3.3.2 Cotton yarn The cotton used in the manufacture of the yarn shall be cleaned, carded, Drawn, spun, and twisted into a ply yarn. The yarn size shall be not coarser than 12/2.

3.3.3 Wood The wood used for the mold shall be clear, straight grained hardwood of a Species listed below. The wood shall be free from checks or other defects Which might affect serviceability.

Ash, white	Locust, black
Birch, sweet or yellow	Maple, sugar or black (hard)
Beech	Oak, red or white
Elm, rock	Pecan

3.3.4 Wire Wire used for interlocking the skirt heading shall be a suitable nonferrous metal Wire, number 36.

3.4 Design Design shall be a twisted cord with a tassel at each end (see figure 1).

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3.5 Color The colors of the component parts shall be as specified in table 1. The rayon or cotton yarns used in component parts of the cord and tassels shall be dyed. When cotton yarn is used as a core for the rayon yarns, the cotton and rayon yarns shall be match for color. Each color shall match the cable number as specified in table I. The use of sulfur dyes and dyes containing elementary sulfur or compounds capable of oxidation to sulfuric acid is prohibited. The dyestuffs shall be chosen and applied so that the dyed yarn shall show no more free or sulfide sulfur than the standard sample when tested as specified in 4.4.1.

TABLE I Colors of cords and tassel components

Class	Cord	Cable NO.	Braid over wood mould	Skirt	Crouse and bezer cord
1	Old Glory Red White National Flag Blue	67156 67101 67124	Old Glory Red White National Flag Blue	Old Glory Red White National Flag Blue	Old glory Red - -
2	Defense Blue White	67117 67101	Defense Blue -	Defense Blue -	Defense Blue -
3	Scarlet White	67111 67101	Scarlet White	Scarlet White	Scarlet -
4	Old Glory Blue White	67178 67101	Old Glory Blue White	Old Glory Blue White	Old Glory Blue -
5	Ultramarine Blue Air Force Yellow	67118 67103	Ultramarine Blue Air Force Yellow	Ultramarine Blue Air Force Yellow	Ultramarine Blue -
6	Silver Gray Black Golden Yellow	67137 67138 67104	Silver Gray Black Golden Yellow	Silver Gray Black Golden Yellow	- Black -
7	Golden Yellow	67104	Golden Yellow	Golden Yellow	Golden Yellow
8	Scarlet Golden Yellow	67111 67104	- Golden Yellow	Scarlet Golden Yellow	Scarlet -
9	Silver Gray Black	67137 67138	Silver Gray Black	Silver Gray Black	Silver Gray -

3.5.1 Matching The color shall match the approved standard shade under natural (north sky) daylight or artificial daylight having a color temperature of 7500 degree Kelvin and shall be good approximation to the standard shade under incandescent lamplight at 2800 degree Kelvin.

3.5.2 Colorfastness. The dyed material shall show fastness to wet- dry cleaning, crocking and light equal to our better than the color standard samples have not been established the dyed material shall show good fastness to wet-dry cleaning, crocking

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3.6 Constructions.

3.6.1 Cords the finished cord shall be not less than 1/4 inch nor greater than 5/16 inch diameter and shall have a minimum of one turn of twist per inch. The cord shall be constructed of 3 strands twisted together. Each strand shall have 40 ends of 12/2 cotton thread as a core and machine wound with 15 ends or hand wound with 6 ends of 300 denier rayon. When 3 colors are used then there shall be 2 strand of first named color and 1 strand of second color.

3.6.2 Tassels The tassels for the various classes shall be composed of rayon yarn, The tassel shall consist of a braided covered wood mould with a fringe or skirt attached to the bottom of the mould. The color effect for braided cover which contains two or more color (see Table I) shall be achieved by alternating each color of series of three carriers on a 72-carier machine with a two over and two under plain stich, This braiding shall be accomplished by the use of 3 ends of 300 denier rayon yarn per carrier.

3.6.2.1 Wood mould (for tassels) A wood mould of the dimensions and shape shown in figure I, shall be turned from a type of wood specified in 3.3.3 and shall be covered with braid.

3.6.2.2 Fringe or skirt bullion The fringe shall consist of a skiet with a bullion length of 4 ± 1/4 inches containing 69 ± 2 pieces of bullion in colors specified in table I. When two or more colors are specified, they shall be altered around the skirt. In addition, there shall be attached to the bullion 4 length of bezer cord (a Twisted braid) 4 ± 1/4 inches in length and of the color specified in table I. The bezer cord shall be spaced evenly around the circumference of the skirt. The bullion shall be composed of five ends of 12/2 cotton as a core and wound with 4 ends of 300 denier rayon with a minimum of three turns per inch. The bezer cord shall consist of a core composed of not less than 9 ends nor more than 20 ends of 12/2 cotton wound with sufficient ends of 300 denier rayon for a covering and twisted in a corkscrew fashion around one end of 12/2 cotton yarn. The heading of the skirt shall be flush against the head end and the skirt shall be lashed together by 4 ends of interlocking wire (see 3.3.4). Two ends of cotton thread and 4 ends of interlocking wire shall lash the twisted braid to the skirt bullion.

4 VERIFICATION.

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 First article inspection. When a first article is required, inspection shall be made on a completely fabricated flag or flags, the number of which shall be determined by the contract or purchase order, for all provisions applicable to end item examination and tests.

4.3 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be made in accordance with the previsions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated herein.

4.3.1 Testing of components. Testing shall be performed on the components listed in Table III for the characteristics shown therein. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the AQL shall be 6.5 test failures per 100 units. The unit of product to be tested shall be as stated in parentheses in the "component" column unless otherwise specified by the selected test method.

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TABLE II. **Testing of Components.**

Component	Characteristic	Rqm't paragraph	Test 1 method	#determ Per s/u	Result Reported as
Rayon yarn for Cord, fringe or Skirt, crouse Cord and bezer Cord	Material identi	3.3.1 and 3.6.2.3	1500 or 1520	1	Pass or fail
	Size of yarn	3.3.1 and 3.6.2.3	4021	1	Nearest whole Number
	NO. of filaments	3.3.1 and 3.6.2.3	Visual	1	Nearest number
	Sulfur content	3.5	4.4.1	1	Pass or fail
	Colorfastness to:				
	Light	3.5.2	4660	1	
	Crocking	3.5.2	4650	1	
	Wet-dry cleaning	3.5.2	4622	1	
Cotton stuffer Yarn for core Of a cord, bezer Cord and Crouse cord	Material identi	3.3.2 and 3.6.2.2	1200	1	Pass or fail
	Size of yarn	3.3.2 and 3.6.2.2	4020	1	Nearest whole number
	Ply of yarn	3.3.2 and 3.6.2.2	Visual		Nearest number
	Sulfur content	3.5	4.4.1	1	Pass or fail
	Colorfastness to:				
	Light	3.5.2	4660	1	
	Crocking	3.5.2	4650	1	
	Wet-dry cleaning	3.5.2	4622	1	

1/ Test method reference are from FED-STD-191

4.3.1.1 Certification of compliance Components and materials listed below may be accepted based on a contractor' s certification of compliance for characteristics indicated.

Component	Characteristic	Rqm't para
Wire	Material Identification	3.3.4
Wood	Species Identification	3.3.3

4.3.2 In-process inspection Inspection shall be made at any point or during any phase of the manufacturing process to determine whether operations or assemblies are accomplished as specified. The Government reserves the right to exclude form consideration for acceptance any material for which in-process inspection has indicated nonconformance. In-process inspection shall be conducted to see that accomplishment of the following is in accordance with the specification requirements.

Assembly and operation	Rqrm't para
Assembly of excessive braid at both ends of wood mould.	3.6.2.1
Assembly of Crouse cord to mould.	3.6.1
Assembly of bullion skirt to head end of the mould.	3.6.2.2
Assembly of finished cord to tassel component.	3.6.2

4.3.3. Inspection of end item

4.3.3.1 Visual examination of cord and tassels The defects found during examination shall be classified in accordance with 4.3.3.1.1 and 4.3.3.1.2. The lots shall be inspected in accordance with 4.3.3.1.3. The unit of product for this examination shall be one completely fabricated cord and tassels.

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4.3.3.1.1 Examination of cord and tassels, for defects in design, material, construction, and workmanship Defect designated by asterisk (*) shall be classified as a major when seriously affecting appearance or serviceability and minor when affecting appearance or serviceability but not seriously.

TABLE III **Examination of cord and tassels**

EXAMINE	DEFECT	MAJOR	(*)	MINOR
Cords	Class other than specified……	X	-	-
	Color or color combination not as specified……	X	-	-
	Not fabricated from specified material……...	X	-	-
	Spot, stain or soiled……..	-	*	-
	Has objectable odor…….	-	-	X
	Core not completely covered……..	-	*	-
	Cut, tear or other imperfection……	-	*	-
	Frayed edges……	-	*	-
	Cord other than required construction……...	X	-	-
	Pulled Thread (s)……...	-	*	-
	Cord does not continue length, I.e., pieced……..	-	-	X
Tassels	Wood mould not covered with specified material……	X	-	-
	Not fabricated from specified material……..	X	-	-
	Wood mould not completely covered with braiding……..	-	*	-
	Wood loosely or unevenly covered……	-	*	-
	Evidence that contour of wood mould is not specified……	-	*	-
	Covering or fringe cord frayed or damage……	-	*	-
	Pulled thread (s)……	-	*	-
	Braid ends not securely glued as required……	-	*	-
	Spot, stain or soiled……..	-	*	-
	Any component missing……...	X	-	-
	Cut, tear or other imperfection……	-	*	-
	Crouse cord not banded as required……..	X	-	-
	Crouse cord does not corkscrew twist effect……	-	-	X
	Fringe not fabricated from specified material……	X	-	-
	Fringe insecurely or not neatly attached……	-	*	-
	Fringe not attached as specified……	-	*	-
	Fringe not alternating colors (when 2 or more colors are used)……	-	-	X
	Ends of fringe uneven……..	-	*	-
	Bezer cord not positioned equidistant around the circumference of The skirt……..	-	*	-
	Bezer cord not twisted as required……..	-	-	X

4.3.3.1.2 Examination of cord and tassel, for defects in dimension Any dimension that is not within the specified tolerances shall be classified as a defect.

4.3.3.1.3 Inspection levels and AQL's The inspection levels and acceptable quality levels (AQL's) expressed in defect per hundred units shall be as follows:

	Inspection Level	AQL Major	AQL Total
For defect applicable to 4.3.3.1.1	I	2.5	6.5
For defect applicable to 4.3.3.1.2	S-3	one class	4.0

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4.3.3.2 Testing of the end Testing of the completely fabricated cord and tassels, Flag shall be performed in accordance with Table IV below for the characteristics shown herein. The sample unit shall be three completely fabricated cord and tassels, flag. The inspection level shall be S-1 and the acceptable quality level shall be 6.5. Requirements are applicable to the individual unit.

TABLE IV **Testing ends**

Characteristic	Rqm't para	1/ Test method	# Deters per s/u	Results Reported as
Cords:				
Color of rayon and Cotton yarn	3.5, 3.6.1 & Table 1	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Color combination	3.6.1 & table 1	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Diameter	3.6.1	Std. Com'1	2	Average of 2 determ to
Turns per inch	3.6.1	4050	1	Nearest 1/32 inch
Number of strands	3.6.1	Visual	1	Nearest number
Number of rayon wound ends	3.6.1	Visual	1	Nearest number
Tassels:				
Color of rayon yarns in braided covers	3.5, 3.6.2 & table1	Visual	1	Nearest whole number
Color combination of braided covers	3.6.2, & table 1	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Braiding stich of cover	3.6.2	Std com'1	1	Pass or fail
Number of braiding ends per carrier in cover	3.6.2 2/	Visual	1	Pass or fail
Number of carriers fringe or skirt	3.6.2 2/	Visual	1	Nearest number
Bullion of tassel:				
Color of rayon and cotton yarn	3.5, 3.6.2.2 & table 1	Visual	1	Nearest number
Color combination	3.6.2.2 & table 1	Visual	1	
Bullion length	3.6.2.2	Std com'1	2	Pass or fail
Number of shots per bullion length	3.6.2.2	Std com'1	1	Pass or fail Average of 2 determ to the nearest 1/16 inch
Number of lengths of twisted braid (bezer cord)	3.6.2.2	Visual	1	Nearest whole number
Length of twisted braid (bezer cord)	3.6.2.2	Std com'1	2	Nearest number
Number of bullion ends	3.6.2.2	Std com'1	1	Average of 2 determ to the nearest 1/16 inch
Number of rayon wound ends for bullion	3.6.2.2	Visual	1	Nearest number
Turn per inch	3.6.2.2	4050	1	Nearest whole number
Number of twisted braid ends (bezer cord)	3.6.2.2	Std com'1	1	
Size of twisted brain core yarn	3.6.2.2 2/	4020	1	

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TABLE IV **Testing ends.** – continued

Characteristic	Rqm't para	1/ test method	#determ Per s/u	Results Reported as
Fly twisted braid core yarn	3.6.2.2	Visual	1	Nearest number
Number of cotton thread ends	3.6.2.2	Visual	1	Nearest number
Wire of tassels:				
Number of interlocking wire ends	3.6.2.2	Visual	1	Nearest number
Crouse cord of tassels:				
Color of rayon and cotton yarns	3.5,3.6.2.3 table 1	Visual	1	Nearest number
Number of strands	3.6.2.3	Visual	1	Nearest number
Number of core ends	3.6.2.3	Visual	1	Nearest whole number
Number of rayon wound ends	3.6.2.3	Visual	1	Nearest number
Number of crimped rayon yarn ends	3.6.2.3	Visual	1	Nearest number
Color of couse cord rayon bands	3.6.2.3 & table 1	Visual	1	Pass or fail

1/ Test method referenced are from FED-STD-191.

2/ Contractor may submit a certificate of compliance for this characteristic.

4.3.3.3 Examination for count of cord and tassels , flag in intermediate containers Cord and tassels, flag packaged for shipment shall be examined to determine conformance with package markings and specified quantity. The sample unit for this examination shall be one box (interior package). Any box containing less than the specified or marked quantity of cord and tassels, Flag shall be classified as defect. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units. The lot size shall be the number of intermediate containers.

4.3.3.4 Examination of preparation for delivery requirements An examination shall be made to determine that the applicable packaging, and marking requirements are complied with. Defects shall be scored in accordance with the list below. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it needs to be sealed. Defects of closures listed below shall be examined on shipping container fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping container in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 and the AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted, incorrect, illegible, or improper size, location, Sequence , or method of applicable

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Material	Any component missing. Any component damaged, affecting serviceability.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of case liner, container, flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of containers. Unit packages not heated sealed.
Weight	Gross/net weight exceeds requirements.
Content	Number of intermediate packages is more less than required.

4.4 Test method

4.4.1 Test for sulfur content

4.4.1.1 Solution (acid stannous chloride) Dissolve 100 grams of stannous crystals in 100 ml. of distilled water.

4.4.1.2 Procedure one to 1.5 grams of the finished yarn, cut into small lengths, shall be used for the test. Place the sample in a test tube of suitable size and cover with stannous chloride solution. Place a filter paper which has been moistened with one drop pf 5.0 percent lead acetate solution (made by dissolving 5 grams of reagent grade lead acetate to 100 ml. of distilled water; add a drop of glacial acetic acid to clear up if cloudy) over the mouth of the tube (punch needle hole in paper). Heat the tube slowly over a low flame until the solution is boiling. The solution shall not be boiled for more than10 to 15 seconds as prolonged boiling will reduce the sensitivity of the test. A brown to black stain appearing on the paper indicated the presence of sulfur.

4.4.1.3 Evaluation The stained filter paper shall be compared with that obtained from standard. If the stained area is equal to or lighter than the standard in degree of staining, the sample shall be considered satisfactory. If the degree of staining by the sample is more than the standard, the sample shall be considered unsatisfactory.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packaging. For acquisition purposes, the packaging requirements shall be as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). When actual packaging of materiel is to be performed by DoD or in-house contractor personnel these personnel need to contact the responsible packaging activity to ascertain requisite packaging requirements. Packaging requirements are maintained by the Inventory Control Point's packaging activities within the Military Service or Defense Agency, or within the military service's system commands. Packaging data retrieval is available from the managing Military Department's or Defense Agency's automated packaging files, CD-ROM products, or by contacting the responsible packaging activity.

6 NOTES

6.1 Intended use The cord with tassels covered by this specification are to be used with flags as indicated.

Class 1 - Old Glory Red, White, and National Flag Blue
- (a) National colors
- (b) President of the United State of America.

Class 2 - Defense Blue and White
- (a) Chairman Joint Chief of Staff
- (b) Secretary of Defense
- (c) Deputy Secretary of Defense

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(d) Director of Defense Research and Engineering

Class 3 - Scarlet and White

(a) Assistant Secretaries of Defense
(b) Secretary of the Army
(c) Under Secretary of the Army
(d) Chief of Staff
(e) Vice Chief of Staff
(f) General of the Army

Class 4 - Old Glory Blue and White

(a) Vice President of the United State of America
(b) Assistant Secretaries of the Army
(c) Coast Guard Standard

Class 5 - Ultramarine Blue and Air Force Yellow

(a) Secretary of the Air Force
(b) Under Secretary and Assistant Secretaries of the Air Force
(c) Chief of Staff Air Force
(d) High Commissioner of the Ryukyu Island

Class 6 - Silver Gray, Black, and Golden Yellow

(a) United State Corps of Cadets

Class 7 - Golden Yellow

(a) Secretary of the Navy
(b) Under Secretary of the Navy
(c) Assistant Secretaries of the Navy
(d) NCO and Staff Officers

Class 8 - Scarlet and Golden Yellow

(a) Marine Corps Standard

Class 9 - Silver Gray and Black

(a) United State Space Force Standard

6.2 Ordering data Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of the specification
(b) Class required (see 1.2)
(c) when a first article sample is not required (see 3.2)
(d) Selection of Applicable levels of Packaging and Packing (see 5.1)

6.3 Sample For access to samples, address the precuring office issuing the invitation for bids

6.4 Color cable numbers The original of the cable numbers included in this specification are as follow:

THE STANDARD COLOR REFERENCE OF AMERICA, 10TH EDITION and supplement, THE U.S. ARMY COLOR CARD

6.5 CHANGES FROM PREVIOUS ISSUE: Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extent of the changes.

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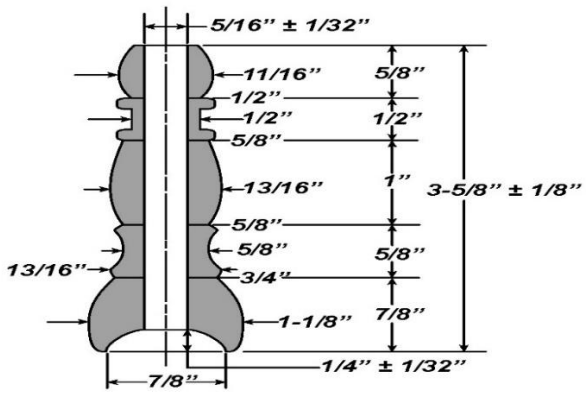


FIGURE 1

Custodians:
Army - IH
Navy - NU
Air Force – 11

Preparing activity:
Army - IH

Review activities:
Navy - MC, CG1
DLA - CT

(Project No. 8345-2024-007)

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